

Workshop Scenarios

Five federated workflows to try

Each scenario is a realistic research task that closes in on a result set you can use in the interface or export. Pick the one nearest your practice or work through several.

Two tips before you start

- If an inference node is slow or inconsistent, switch its model to **arc:nano** — it is the fastest and most predictable — and keep prompts tightly constrained (*"reply with one word"*, *"a four-digit year only"*).
- Add **Comment nodes** as you go. Your reasoning — what you included, excluded, trusted, doubted — is the most valuable data this workshop can collect.

1 Build a citable early modern text corpus

For literary scholars and historical linguists — LLDS, Bodleian

The task: Assemble a corpus of printed texts by, or attributed to, a single author or printer within a date range — the kind of set you would take into Voyant, AntConc or R.

Getting started: Param (author or topic) → LLDSSearch + BodleianSearch → TableOutput. Then FilterTransform: keep *type = Text*, restrict *date* to your range, drop records with no creator.

Forks to try: Attribution is the hard part — multiple name forms exist ("Lily, William, 1468?–1522" vs bare surnames). Try Reconciliation on *creator* to collapse variants under one Wikidata identity, then MergeByQID. Does the reconciled corpus differ from your filtered one?

Finish: Citation node for the reference list; Export as CSV or JSON.

Comment node: State your inclusion criteria — what counts as "by" this author, and which records you excluded on attribution grounds.

Search terms to try

Search term	Why it works
<code>`donne`</code>	Large EEBO-TCP presence; attribution mess is right: sermons, poems, spurious works, name variants — a good reconciliation test.
<code>`tyndale`</code>	Fewer, cleaner records; translation and edition complexity.
<code>`aesop`</code>	Tests author-vs-subject: editions of Aesop with translators in the creator field — a harder reconciliation case.
<code>`sermon` (1640–1660)</code>	High volume; forces deliberate FilterTransform use on date range.

2 A monument-type gazetteer for a region

For archaeologists — ARIADNE, HSDS

The task: Produce a geo-referenced dataset of fieldwork records for one monument type or period in one region — something you could load into QGIS.

Getting started: ARIADNEsearch (monument type or period term) → MapOutput. Draw a bounding box to filter spatially; inspect what survives in the Table.

Forks to try: Some records carry no coordinates — wire those through Geocoding (gazetteer route) using the place name field, and compare resolved points against the records that arrived with coordinates. Where do they disagree, and which would you trust? FieldDistribution on subject or period to check set coherence.

Finish: Export as GeoJSON.

Comment node: Record your bounding box rationale and how you treated geocoded (as opposed to natively georeferenced) records — a GIS user downstream needs to know which is which.

Search terms to try

Search term	Why it works
`hillfort`	Abundant in ARIADNE; strongly regional (Wessex or Welsh Marches bounding box works well); useful mix of georeferenced and coordinate-free records.
`barrow`	Very high volume — tests whether you thin sensibly. The Barrow-in-Furness place collision is a useful teaching point.
`souterrain` / `crannog`	Lower volume, sharply regional (Scotland/Ireland); tidier for a quick run.

3 A scientific sample dataset for re-analysis

For heritage scientists — HSDS

The task: Gather every analytical record — radiocarbon determinations, material analyses — for one site or material, structured cleanly enough to take into OxCal or a spreadsheet.

Getting started: HSDSsearch (site name) → TableOutput. Titles carry sample numbers; descriptions carry material and context.

Forks to try: The *description* field mixes material, context and place in one string. Use `KingsInferenceByField` (per-record, arc:nano) to extract just the material: *"From this description, state only the material sampled, in one or two words."* Compare the inferred column against the raw descriptions before trusting it.

Finish: Export as CSV.

Comment node: Note which fields are machine-derived and would need verification before publication.

Search terms to try

Search term	Why it works
`radiocarbon vindolanda`	Well-sampled site with multiple determinations.
`radiocarbon flag fen` / `must farm`	Alternative well-sampled sites.
`beeswax` / `charcoal`	Material-first rather than site-first; the inference extraction is exercised because material sits inside description prose.
`sutton hoo`	Offline fallback — fixture already bundled.

4 A collections audit across institutions

For museum professionals and material-culture researchers — MDS, V&A, SMG

The task: How is one class of object — scientific instruments, samplers, commemorative ceramics — distributed across UK collections, and how consistently is it described?

Getting started: The same Param into MDSSearch + VAMSearch + SMGSearch → merged TableOutput → SourceProfile. The profile's field-completeness view *is* the audit: which institutions record maker? Date? Place?

Forks to try: FieldDistribution on type/category fields to see how differently the three services classify the same kind of thing. FilterTransform to normalise an inconsistent field (e.g. uppercase object types) before comparing.

Finish: Export as CSV with the source column retained.

Comment node: Summarise the documentation gaps you found — cross-institution evidence of this kind is currently hard to come by.

Search terms to try

Search term	Why it works
`microscope`	Strong in SMG, present in V&A; (design) and MDS (regional museums); classification differences across the three are instructive.
`sampler`	Strong V&A, decent MDS, weak SMG — the asymmetry is itself an audit finding.
`sundial`	Good three-way spread, manageable volumes.
`teapot`	High volume in V&A/MDS if a bigger set is wanted.

5 Enrich a thin result set into a usable one

For anyone whose records arrive under-described — any source

The task: Take a result set whose key field is missing or buried in prose, derive it with inference, verify it, and export the enriched set.

Getting started: Any search → TableOutput. Identify the gap: no date column, no place, no object type. KingsInferenceByField (per-record, arc:nano) with a tightly constrained prompt: *"From this description, extract only the year of creation as a four-digit number, or 'unknown'."*

Forks to try: Run the same extraction with two differently-worded prompts and compare columns — how stable is the result? Then put the derived field to work: a Timeline or Map that was impossible before the enrichment.

Finish: Export as JSON, derived fields included.

Comment node: Record the exact prompt used — a derived dataset without its provenance is precisely the citation problem this project keeps encountering.

Search terms to try

Search term	Why it works
<code>`medal` / `banner`</code> (MDS)	Regional museum records are reliably under-described; dates often live in prose or nowhere.
<code>`portrait` (Bodleian)</code>	Dates like "18th century" or blank — ideal for the year-extraction prompt and a before/after Timeline.
Any HSDS search	<i>spatialCoverage</i> : "Name not provided" with the place sitting in the description is the canonical enrichment case.

Facilitator note: Run each primary term live and confirm the result count lands in the 15–60 range before the session — below that the FieldDistribution looks sparse; above it inference forks get slow. Capture the fixture in the same session so the offline set matches the handout exactly. Remove this note before distributing.